

patterns on white glaze, with blossoms shaking slightly in many carriages, feathers seeming ready to come out at one's call, a charming sight of landscapes, matched with delicate and pretty calligraphic works of graceful verses together with bright red seals, which merged the verse, calligraphy, painting and seal into one organic whole, magnificently conceived. Even mere the landscape in just red and blue colours and the plums in single black colour could also gladden the heart and refresh the mind. Characterised by its "Graceful, Beautiful, and Exquisite" aesthetic style, the coloured enamel porcelains made during Yongzheng Reign became the glaring treasures in imperial palaces and art circles. Influenced by the enamel, the artistic style of Yongzheng *Fencai* turned mature, which was delicate, pretty and robust in strokes, with lines long or short, curved or straight, smooth and flexible, matched with the ways of shading and dyeing, it revealed the texture and space of objects. Its colours were bright, gorgeous, gentle and beautiful, and some pigments should have a slender layer of "glass whiteness (a kind of bright opaque white colour)" as the ground and "contrasted out (or washing and dyeing)" their density or lightness, brightness or darkness with other colours. After being burned at low temperature, the "glass whiteness" integrated with the pigments, making the colours even more embellished and graceful. It had lots of techniques of expression, absorbing the meticulous painting skills of flowers-birds drawing; and especially influenced by the academic painting style of the Qing Dynasty, it was well-knit and clear, with lifelike figures. The Yongzheng *Fencai* brought the decorative art of porcelains into a new graceful, exquisite state, which stood for the whole style and features of this time.

CONTRASTING COLOURS Using the cobalt blue pigment to sketch the outline of the pattern on the earth body, then applying the *Fencai* pigment in it after the earth body had been fired and became a porcelain body, and arranging them contrastingly into an integrated colourful pattern. It was not only as bright and beautiful as *Fencai*, but also as simple and elegant as *Qinghua*, bringing out the best in each other. This kind of technique was initiated in Yongzheng Reign, making it fresh and new. The contrasting coloured products, imitating on the "chicken cup" and the pot with 天 character on the basis of Chenghua contrasting colour, looking almost genuine in all properties of body, glaze slip, modelling and decoration.

COLOUR GLAZE The colour glazed porcelains made in Yongzheng Reign were characterised, firstly, by its imitation of ancient products as a method to inherit the tradition, to learn from the experience of famous kilns of past times, and to make use of

techniques created by predecessors so as to let the traditions of famed kilns in the South Song Dynasty across the country take root and blossom in Jingdezhen. Secondly, it absorbed strong points of others and brought its own advantages into full play and thus formed new style and features. Taking the products imitation on the Jun glaze as an example, the colour glaze slip was blown onto its hard, fine, white and smooth body after the unglazed body had been fired, which was much more advanced compared with the method to directly apply glaze to the rough and brown body in the Jun kiln. By adulterating the kiln slag into glaze slip and letting them run at the high temperature to bring along the red-purple glaze to naturally form threads of patterns in different designs, such kind of photochromic fence glaze had both brilliant purples and reds as of the Jun kiln glaze and a riot of gorgeous colours got by magic hand. Thirdly, the same variety of product could have varied colours derived from the difference in firing atmosphere. For instance, the tea dust glaze was of the pure colour in green with yellow, the eel yellow glaze was yellowish; and the crab-shell blue glaze and the old-mafor-coloured glaze were both greenish. The glaze imitating on the Guan glaze had its grains like eel blood, of classic elegance and good taste; the one imitating on the Ge glaze was like the gold and iron wire, out of nature; the one imitating on the Ru glaze was just like the blue sky after a rainstorm, bright and limpid; the Dong celadon glaze, the pale blue glaze and the pea green glaze were all precisely made, with a stable and glaring colour; and other red, yellow, blue and green glazes, like the turquoise green glaze, the eggplant purple glaze, and the oven Jun glaze, vied each other for beauty, capturing the mind and pleasing the eyes.

By Yongzheng Reign, the *Qinghua* and the underglaze red entered another aesthetic state, with their hues becoming fresh green but luxuriant, brilliant red but composed, and the pattern scattered but animated. To pursue the effect of natural halos and the charm of calmness of black flaws and speckles in the Xuande *Qinghua*, some scattered or dense, big or small spots were deliberately made while drawing patterns so as to make them stand out. The patterns of the underglaze red were bright in colour and clear in lines. If the *Qinghua* and the underglaze red were used together for decoration, it would form a delightful contrast between the red flowers and green leaves.

The modelling of Yongzheng porcelain was of innovation. The designers imitated the states of flowers and fruits from the nature, then refined, exaggerated, and deformed them into such products as the pomegranate *Zun* and the olive-shaped vase. Some parts of utensils were moulded with the form of flowers or fruits, such as